CROSS-BORDER NOTES

On August 7, a Uzbek bank went on state television and said it is converting to Islamic finance.

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Banks don't reframe their operating model for a retail campaign. They do it when the regulator signals where capital is allowed to come from next.

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Gulf capital lands where the plumbing already exists. Sharia-compliant balance sheets are the entry ticket, not a courtesy.

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Regulatory intent precedes capital. If Tashkent normalizes Islamic finance at the bank level, sovereign issuance tends to follow.

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The route is being built from the receiving end. Central Asian banks are doing the compliance work before any Gulf institution asks.

> **Treat it like a central bank circular, not a press release. Whoever converts first sets the terms for the capital that follows.**

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